

Remove the defender with a purpose

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

Capturing, deflecting, or overloading a defender can make a protected target vulnerable. First identify the defender's essential job. Then calculate whether removing it really allows the intended gain, including intermediate checks and replacement defenders.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A bishop guards a mating square and a rook. Forcing it to recapture elsewhere may abandon the mating square. If another piece can take over the defense, the apparent removal may accomplish nothing.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you name before sacrificing to remove a defender?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The exact target that becomes vulnerable and the move that exploits it. A sacrifice without a follow-up is merely a material loss unless compensation is demonstrated.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Target the defender's job, then prove the follow-up.